

Hunting for game

Dear Digit Team,
You should provide more gaming articles and should try to review the latest international games instead of featuring old ones like Tropico which was released almost a year ago.

Shoeb Khan
Via e-mail



Dear Shoeb,
Our Arcade section was introduced with just this intention of serving the needs of passionate gamers like you. Unfortunately computer games, like foreign movies take around two-four months to make their way to the Indian shores. This introduces a time lag between our reviews and their international release date. While we could talk about games before their actual release (like in our Sneak Peeks article in March), we think it's more useful to discuss those games that you can actually go out and buy. And you can always taste the latest games on our Playware CD.

digit

Net benefits

Hello!
I have a suggestion: can you provide us with free Internet hours every month? Sounds awkward but it will surely increase your popularity with your readers.

Via e-mail

digit

Dear Sherry,
Providing free Net access is very similar to movie trailers or demo software. You whet your audience's appetite just a little bit to make sure that they come back for the full movie or the commercial version of the software. ISPs carry out these sampling activities with the hope that some satisfied users might convert into paying customers. We've done similar exercises in the past with some ISPs and will continue to provide this whenever possible, but doing it month after month might not be feasible (for the ISPs at least).

Head 2 Head

And the Intel vs AMD debate continues...

Dear Sirs,
I just got hold of your April issue and I saw the letter from Nitin on AMD processors. The AMD Athlon/Duron processors are virtual time bombs in the sense that they do not have a cutover transistor, which automatically shuts off the CPU in the case of a heat overload (The P-III simply hangs). Also, the P4 continues working when the external fans are taken off (this was demonstrated by a popular hardware Web site) but the Athlon simply flames away. My take is that if a CPU is okay at the start, it will work properly for the rest of its life. But a fan has moving mechanical parts that can fail, and when it does, there will be fireworks.

Ajay Puri
Via e-mail



Dear Digit,
I've been a computer buff since 1995 when I assembled my first computer. It was an AMD 386. It worked at a measly 40 MHz but was all of 7 MHz faster than Intel's 33 MHz 386. Since then I have had an AMD K62 400 MHz and now I have an AMD Athlon 1.13 GHz. No regrets. My respect for AMD has only grown over time. Also, there's another angle to all of this: Intel prices its CPUs higher than AMD, which means that both Intel and the vendor make more money (assuming their manufacturing costs are similar). Therefore, Intel has more money to advertise and can create more noise about their Pentium CPUs. So AMD stands absolutely no chance of producing a chip that overheats and is not stable as every other factor is against them.

This is where frank magazines like Digit play a huge role.

PS: I do not keep my computer in an air-conditioned room.

Squadron Leader H.P. Kumar
Via e-mail

Short Bytes

Thank you

Dear Sir,
Thanks to Digit, I can actively participate in technical discussions with my friends who have a computer background even though I'm not a computer professional. Sometimes they even come to me for rectifying software/hardware problems.

Dr Jignesh Pandya

Agent 001 in the crossfire

Dear Karan,
This is in reference to Balachandrar's letter saying that Agent 001 is a complete waste of space (April 2002). I think that Agent 001 brings to light what an Indian consumer feels and can expect from the market. Don't stop Agent 001!

Sanjul Dhawan
Via e-mail

Goof Ups

■ In the monitor comparison test on page 54, Proview PA-566 15-inch monitor is shown with the 'Best Performance Award' logo. Instead, this monitor was the recipient of our 'Best Value Award' in the 15-inch category.

■ A lot of our readers have complained that the demo of Medal of Honor was corrupted and the installation would abort abruptly after some time. We've put a fresh (and working) demo on this month's Mindware CD.

Notice any goof-ups? Write to goof@jasubhai.com

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